religion of Hinduism and quite gratuitously blames writers like Aurobindo, Hiriyanna, and Radhakrishnan for being inspired by Christian influence for propagating the view that the world is not an illusion, for surely Hinduism is much older than any one or all of them.

Zaehner sees in Indian philosophy—except in Rāmānuja—only the absorption of man into the Absolutistic Brahman. One wonders how anybody could see nothing but monism in the varied schools of Indian philosophy, when everybody should know that Absolute Monism is only one school out of six notably non-monist but equally, it not more, important schools of Hindu philosophy. That Zaehner had no access to the religiously theistic literature of the Hindus is not altogether his fault, but such sweeping characterizations about the entire philosophical literature as being monistic cannot be justified even after a misreading of the history of Indian philosophy itself. It is difficult to understand how anyone could possibly identify Indian philosophies with Advaita Vedānta, Yoga, or Jainism alone when in every age there have been equally, if not more pervasive philosophical systems constantly opposing it. Advaita Vedānta without its important opponents has never even been mentioned in the philosophical literature of India. Even in the twentieth century, during which time the monistic misrepresentation of India has been so widespread outside India, Advaita Vedānta has had the most uncompromising opponent in the person of Swami Dayananda Śarasvati, who is regarded by his followers as great a philosopher as Sankara himself and who fought all his life most brilliantly against the Absolute Vedāntins throughout the length and breadth of India. This is the philosophical history of India in our own lifetime. Of course, even immediately after Sankara, a whole wave of qualified monisms, dualisms, and pluralisms overwhelmed Absolutism, as it were. One wonders why the factual and objective history in the realms of pure thought and literature of a nation should be as misread as its political history. There may be some justification in misreading political histories of different nations because emotions are difficult to divorce from politics, but there is no reason why this should be done in the realm of the philosophy or the religion of a people. But, of course, as someone has said, religion, too, is after all nothing more than the noblest emotion of man which occasionally can be the worst obsession of a few.

Zaehner has truly emphasized the fact that the Indian religions are empirical, i.e., that they are "man's unaided attempt to come to terms with the divine which cannot therefore be treated as being